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Judge Ignores Appeals From Prominent Supporters

$80,000 COMPROMISE RANSOM SET FOR HUEY P. NEWTON

At a press conference last Tuesday at Oakland Municipal Courthouse, ELAINE BROWN and attorney SHELDON OTIS, chief counsel for Black Panther Party leader HUEY P. NEWTON (left), denounce $80,000 "compromise ransom" set by Judge Courtland Arne. At the bail hearing, prominent individuals gave stirring testimony asking for Huey Newton's release on his own recognizance.

(Oakland, Calif.) - In a move later bitterly denounced as "compromise ransom," Judge Courtland Arne flatly rejected striking legal arguments by attorney Sheldon Otis and strong character witness testimony and affidavits from over two dozen prestigious individuals in denying Black Panther Party founder and leader Huey P. Newton release on his own recognizance, instead reducing his exorbitant $100,000 bail to $80,000.

Arne's unexplained political ploy climaxed a dramatic two and a half hour hearing held here in Oakland-Piedmont Municipal Court last Tuesday morning, a court appearance which also saw Huey officially enter a firm "Not Guilty" plea to the false and slanderous charges lodged against him.

As in Huey's first court appearance on July 5 — held two days following the respected Black Panther Party leader's thrilling return to the Bay Area after close to three years of forced political exile in the friendly confines of the Republic of Cuba — extraordinary security measures were employed by the Alameda County Sherriff's Deputy Department to harass supporters and friends.

Again, a side door entrance to the Department 6 courtroom was used, with all incoming attorneys, potential witnesses, media and supporters subjected to demeaning metal detector "frisk" searches. The tiny 72-seat courtroom was filled quickly, leaving a crowd of some 200 milling in the crowded corridor outside.

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